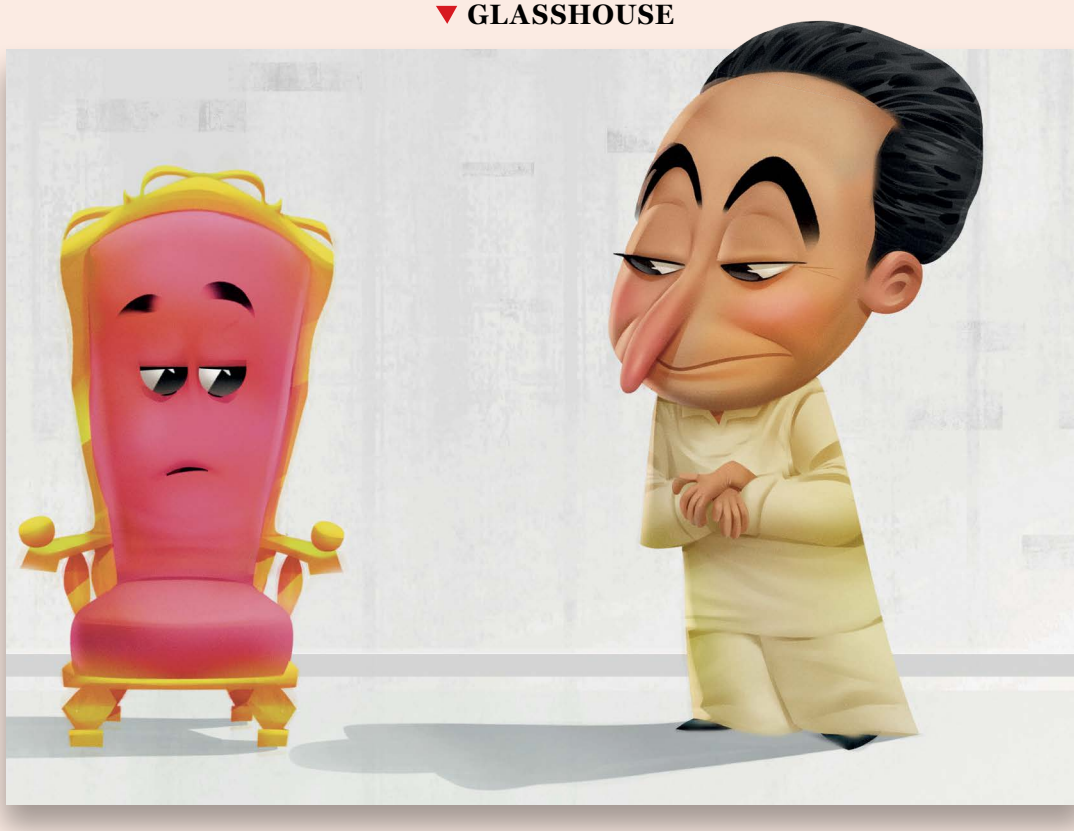
▼ GLASSHOUSE



A CONGRESS KAMAL BLOOMS

Three Rajya Sabha seats from Madhya Pradesh will fall vacant on June 21. The BJP has the numbers to win two, the Congress one. With incumbent Congress MP and ex-chief minister, Digvijaya Singh, 79, calling it quits, another former CM and old-timer, the 79-year-old **Kamal Nath,** has signalled interest. After a prolonged lull, the veteran Congressman is suddenly everywhere, appearing on podcasts and interviews and reminiscing about his ties with the Gandhi family. The math, however, is tight; the Congress needs 58 votes to win its seat and currently has 62 MLAs in the assembly. Two MLAs recently lost voting rights to judicial orders, and with the BJP's well-versed habit of engineering cross-voting, anything can happen. Nath's camp insists he has the heft to hold the flock together. His critics point to 2020, when a Congress government collapsed on his watch. The high command (read Gandhi family) now has to decide who fits the bill.

Illustrations by **SIDDHANT JUMDE**

▼ BUILDING YOGI'S IMAGE

THE PERFECT PICTURE

The occasion was the inauguration of the new Rapti Eco Park in Gorakhpur, showcasing its transformation from a garbage dump to a 'waste to wonder' project. But it was local MP **Ravi Kishan** who stole the show as he stepped up to 'direct' Uttar Pradesh chief minister **Yogi Adityanath**,



who was posing for a photograph next to the statue of a lion in the park. "Maharajji, use the lion's face...take a low angle," the actor-turned-neta gestured, as though calling the shots on a film set. The crowd broke into laughter, prompting even the chief minister to smile at the impromptu lesson in how to 'frame' a picture. And what better than a leonine prop to project an image of power.